

Vlys' Scene Notes Lite

User Documentation

Version 1.0.0

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1. Introduction

Vlys Scene Notes Lite is an editor extension for Unity that allows users to create and manage contextual notes directly inside the Scene View.

The tool is designed to improve communication within development teams by enabling structured scene annotations without relying on external task management systems.

All notes are stored in a single managed asset to reduce version control conflicts and maintain a clean project structure.

This package is intended for solo developers and small to medium-sized teams who require lightweight scene-based documentation and issue tracking.

2. System Requirements

- Unity 2021 LTS or newer

- Compatible with Built-in Render Pipeline, URP, and HDRP
- Editor only tool (no runtime dependency)

The tool does not affect game builds and does not introduce runtime performance overhead.

3. Installation

1. Import the package into your Unity project.
2. Open Unity and load any scene.
3. Open the Scene View window.
4. Locate the Scene Notes overlay button labeled "SN".
5. If the overlay is not visible:
 - Click the three-dot menu in the Scene View.
 - Select Overlay.
 - Enable Scene Notes.

The tool can also be accessed from the top menu:

Tools → Vlys Utilities → Scene Notes

4. Quick Start Guide

To create your first note:

1. Open the Scene View.
2. Click the "SN" overlay button.
3. Press Create Note.
4. Click anywhere inside the Scene View to place the note.
5. Write a description in the Inspector.
6. Click Save.

The note will now appear in the Scene View.

5. Creating Notes

Notes are created directly inside the Scene View.

When creating a note:

- Click Create Note from the overlay.
- Click in the Scene to define its position.
- Optionally link it to a GameObject.
- Assign a category.
- Write a description.
- Save the note.

Notes can be repositioned after creation.

Each note automatically stores metadata including:

- Author
 - Creation date
 - Git branch (if available)
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6. Editing Notes

To modify an existing note:

1. Select the note in the Scene View.
2. Click Enable Editing in the Inspector.
3. Modify any of the following:
 - Description
 - Category
 - Status
 - Position
 - Linked GameObject
4. Click Apply Changes.

Changes are saved into the central note asset.

7. Categories and Status

Each note also includes a status field:

- Open

- In Progress
- Resolved
- Closed

notes can be hidden using the overlay filter to keep the Scene View clean.

8. Filtering and Search

The Scene Notes overlay provides filtering tools to improve workflow efficiency.

Available filters include:

- Filter by category
- Filter by author
- Search by text
- Hide resolved notes

Filtering applies only to the currently active scene.

9. Linking Notes to GameObjects

Notes can be linked to specific GameObjects. This ensures that notes keep a track on GameObjects even if they are moved

If a linked GameObject is deleted:

- The reference can be reassigned manually.
- The note itself remains preserved.

This ensures that information is not lost even if scene objects change.

10. Style Settings

Visual customization is available through:

Tools → Vlys Utilities → Scene Notes → Icon Settings

Users can adjust:

- Icon scale
- Text scale
- Category icons
- General visual presentation settings

These settings allow the tool to adapt to different scene densities and user preferences.

11. Version Control Considerations

All notes are stored inside a single managed asset file.

This design reduces:

- File clutter
- The number of version-controlled assets
- The likelihood of merge conflicts

Notes are marked as deleted instead of being permanently removed from the data structure. This approach minimizes structural changes in the asset file and helps maintain version control stability.

While the system is designed to be merge-friendly, proper version control practices are still recommended when working in team environments. As with any serialized Unity asset, merge conflicts may occur depending on workflow and simultaneous edits.

12. Deleting Notes

Individual notes can be deleted from the Inspector.

To remove all notes in the current scene:

Vlys → Scene Notes → Delete All Notes

Warning:

Using Delete All Notes is not a soft delete and may increase the likelihood of merge conflicts in version control systems such as Git. This action should be used carefully in collaborative environments.

13. Troubleshooting

Overlay not visible:

- Ensure the Scene View overlay is enabled.
- Check the three-dot menu in the Scene View.

Notes not appearing:

- Verify that filters are not hiding them.
- Ensure the note status is not set to Resolved while Hide Resolved is active.

Linked GameObject missing:

- Reassign the reference manually in the Inspector.

branch not detected:

- Currently the system supports only Git Version Control
 - Branch detection depends on the local repository setup.
 - Ensure the project is inside a valid Git repository.
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14. Frequently Asked Questions

Does this tool affect game builds?

No. This is an editor-only extension and does not impact runtime builds.

Is runtime performance affected?

No. The tool operates only inside the Unity Editor.

Can notes be used in multiple scenes?

Notes are scene-specific and filtered per active scene.

Is the tool compatible with different render pipelines?

Yes. The tool works independently of the render pipeline.

15. Support

If you encounter issues or require assistance, please contact:

ulises.j.alvarenga@gmail.com

Please include the following in the email subject line:

Vlys SceneNotes Lite - [Doubt/Bug/Question]

When reporting an issue, include:

- Unity version
- Operating system
- Description of the issue
- Steps to reproduce

Providing complete information will help speed up the support process and resolution time.
